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# IT Project Management Support

Lecture 13

Managing People (2)

Big Five Personality Traits - Five-Factor Model (FFM)

## Literature

- Goldberg, L.R.: An Alternative "Description of Personality": The Big Five Factor Structure. Journal of Personality and Social Psychology, Vol. 59, No. 6, pp. 1216-1229 (1990)
- Kendra Cherry: The Big Five Personality Traits (2020)  
<https://www.verywellmind.com/the-big-five-personality-dimensions-2795422>
- Courtney E. Ackerman: Big Five Personality Traits: The OCEAN Model Explained (2020)  
<https://positivepsychology.com/big-five-personality-theory/>
- The Five-Factor Model  
<http://oer2go.org/mods/en-boundless/www.boundless.com/psychology/textbooks/boundless-psychology-textbook/personality-16/trait-perspectives-on-personality-79/the-five-factor-model-311-12846/index.html>
- Big Five personality traits  
[https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Big\\_Five\\_personality\\_traits](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Big_Five_personality_traits)

## Big Five Personality Traits

- Many psychologists believe that the number of human personality traits can be reduced to five factors, and that all of the other traits fit within these five factors.
- The five factor personality traits show consistency in interviews, self-descriptions, and observations, as well as across a wide range of participants of different ages and from different cultures.
- The acronym **OCEAN** is often used to recall the five factors, and comes from Paul Costa's and Robert McCrae's conceptualization: **Openness to experience, Conscientiousness, Extraversion, Agreeableness**, and **Neuroticism**.
- Critics argue that the five factor model is limited in scope and is not theory-driven; they also point to limitations in its use of factor analysis.



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**Openness**



**Conscientiousness**



**Extraversion**



**Agreeableness**

**The  
Big Five  
Personality  
Traits**



**Neuroticism**

## Openness to Experience

(inventive/curious vs. consistent/cautious)

- This trait includes appreciation for art, emotion, adventure, unusual ideas, curiosity, and variety of experience.
- Openness reflects a person's degree of intellectual curiosity, creativity, and preference for novelty and variety.
- It is also described as the extent to which a person is imaginative or independent; it describes a personal preference for a variety of activities over a strict routine.
- Those who score high in openness to experience prefer novelty, while those who score low prefer routine.

## Conscientiousness

(efficient/organized vs. easy-going/careless)

- This trait refers to one's tendency toward self-discipline, dutifulness, competence, thoughtfulness, and achievement-striving (such as goal-directed behavior).
- It is distinct from the moral implications of "having a conscience"; instead, this trait focuses on the amount of deliberate intention and thought a person puts into his or her behavior.
- Individuals high in conscientiousness prefer planned rather than spontaneous behavior and are often organized, hardworking, and dependable.
- Individuals who score low in conscientiousness take a more relaxed approach, are spontaneous, and may be disorganized.
- Numerous studies have found a positive correlation between conscientiousness and academic success.

## Extraversion

(outgoing/energetic vs. solitary/reserved)

- An individual who scores high on extraversion is characterized by high energy, positive emotions, talkativeness, assertiveness, sociability, and the tendency to seek stimulation in the company of others.
- Those who score low on extraversion prefer solitude and/or smaller groups, enjoy quiet, prefer activities alone, and avoid large social situations.
- Not surprisingly, people who score high on both extroversion and openness are more likely to participate in adventure and risky sports due to their curious and excitement-seeking nature .

## Agreeableness

(friendly/compassionate vs. cold/unkind)

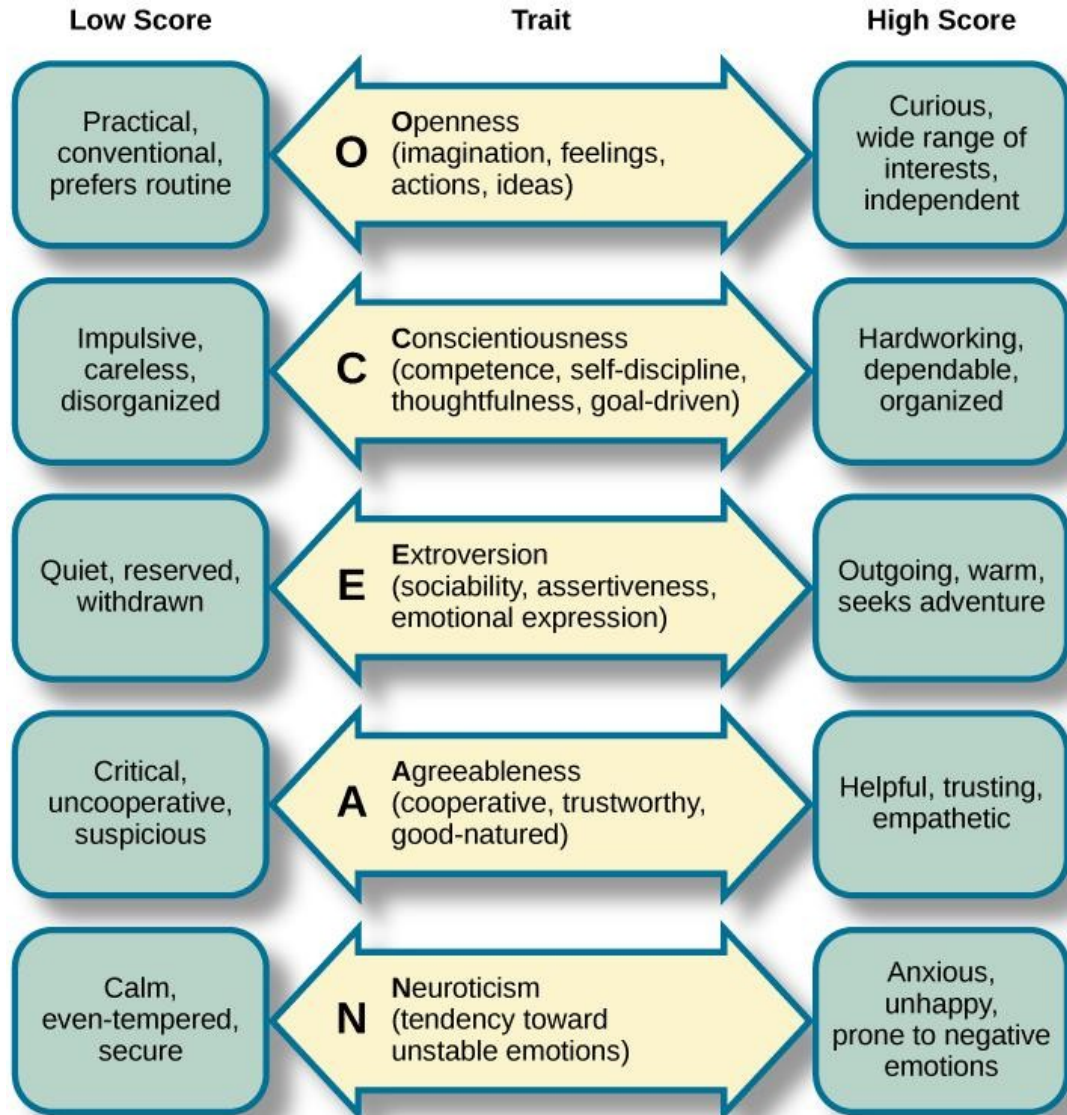
- This trait measures one's tendency to be compassionate and cooperative rather than suspicious and antagonistic towards others.
- It is also a measure of a person's trusting and helpful nature and whether that person is generally well-tempered or not.
- People who score low on agreeableness tend to be described as rude and uncooperative.

# Neuroticism

(sensitive/nervous vs. secure/confident)

- High neuroticism is characterized by the tendency to experience unpleasant emotions, such as anger, anxiety, depression, or vulnerability.
- Neuroticism also refers to an individual's degree of emotional stability and impulse control.
- People high in neuroticism tend to experience emotional instability and are characterized as angry, impulsive, and hostile.
- People reporting high levels of neuroticism also tend to report feeling anxious and unhappy. In contrast, people who score low in neuroticism tend to be calm and even-tempered.

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OCEAN: the Big Five Personality Traits.

It is important to note that each of the five personality factors represents a range between two extremes.

For example, extraversion represents a continuum between extreme extraversion and extreme introversion.

In the real world, most people lie somewhere in between the two polar ends of each dimension.

## Openness to Experience

- Openness to experience has been described as the depth and complexity of an individual's mental life and experiences.
- It is also sometimes called intellect or imagination.
- Openness to experience concerns people's willingness to try to new things, their ability to be vulnerable, and their capability to think outside the box.
- Common traits related to openness to experience include:
  - Imagination;
  - Insightfulness;
  - Varied interests;
  - Originality;
  - Daringness;

## Openness to Experience (2)

- Preference for variety;
  - Cleverness;
  - Creativity;
  - Curiosity;
  - Perceptiveness;
  - Intellect;
  - Complexity/depth.
- An individual who is high in openness to experience is likely someone who has a love of learning, enjoys the arts, engages in a creative career or hobby, and likes meeting new people.
  - An individual who is low in openness to experience probably prefers routine over variety, sticks to what he or she knows, and prefers less abstract arts and entertainment.

## Conscientiousness

- Conscientiousness is a trait that can be described as the tendency to control impulses and act in socially acceptable ways, behaviors that facilitate goal-directed behavior.
- Conscientious people excel in their ability to delay gratification, work within the rules, and plan and organize effectively.
- Traits within the conscientiousness factor include:
  - Persistence;
  - Ambition;
  - Thoroughness;
  - Self-discipline;
  - Consistency;
  - Predictability;

## Conscientiousness (2)

- Control;
  - Reliability;
  - Resourcefulness;
  - Hard work;
  - Energy;
  - Perseverance;
  - Planning.
- People high in conscientiousness are likely to be successful in school and in their careers, to excel in leadership positions, and to doggedly pursue their goals with determination and forethought.
  - People low in conscientiousness are much more likely to procrastinate and to be flighty, impetuous, and impulsive.

## Extroversion

- This factor has two familiar ends of its spectrum: extroversion and introversion.
- It concerns where an individual draws their energy from and how they interact with others.
- In general, extroverts draw energy from or recharge by interacting with others, while introverts get tired from interacting with others and replenish their energy with solitude.
- The traits associated with extroversion are:
  - Sociableness;
  - Assertiveness;
  - Merriness;
  - Outgoing nature;
  - Energy;

## Extroversion (2)

- Talkativeness;
  - Ability to be articulate;
  - Fun-loving nature;
  - Tendency for affection;
  - Friendliness;
  - Social confidence.
- People high in extroversion tend to seek out opportunities for social interaction, where they are often the “life of the party.” They are comfortable with others, are gregarious, and are prone to action rather than contemplation.
  - People low in extroversion are more likely to be people “of few words who are quiet, introspective, reserved, and thoughtful.

## Agreeableness

- This factor concerns how well people get along with others.
- While extroversion concerns sources of energy and the pursuit of interactions with others, agreeableness concerns one's orientation to others.
- It is a construct that rests on how an individual generally interacts with others.
- The traits associated with Agreeableness are:
  - Altruism;
  - Trust;
  - Modesty;
  - Humbleness;
  - Patience;
  - Moderation;
  - Tact;

## Agreeableness (2)

- Politeness;
- Kindness;
- Loyalty
- Unselfishness;
- Helpfulness;
- Sensitivity;
- Amiability;
- Cheerfulness;
- Consideration.

## Agreeableness (3)

- People high in agreeableness tend to be well-liked, respected, and sensitive to the needs of others.
- They likely have few enemies and are affectionate to their friends and loved ones, as well as sympathetic to the plights of strangers.
- People on the low end of the agreeableness spectrum are less likely to be trusted and liked by others.
- They tend to be callous, blunt, rude, ill-tempered, antagonistic, and sarcastic.
- Although not all people who are low in agreeableness are cruel or abrasive, they are not likely to leave others with a warm fuzzy feeling.

## Neuroticism

- Neuroticism is not a factor of meanness or incompetence, but one of confidence and being comfortable in one's own skin. It encompasses one's emotional stability and general temper.
- These traits are commonly associated with neuroticism:
  - Awkwardness;
  - Pessimism;
  - Moodiness;
  - Jealousy;
  - Testiness;
  - Fear;
  - Nervousness;
  - Anxiety;
  - Timidness;

## Neuroticism (2)

- Wariness;
  - Self-criticism;
  - Lack of confidence;
  - Insecurity;
  - Instability;
  - Oversensitivity.
- Those high in neuroticism are generally prone to anxiety, sadness, worry, and low self-esteem. They may be temperamental or easily angered, and they tend to be self-conscious and unsure of themselves.
  - Individuals who score on the low end of neuroticism are more likely to feel confident, sure of themselves, and adventurous. They may also be brave and unencumbered by worry or self-doubt.

## Openness to Experience

- This trait features characteristics such as imagination and insight.
- People who are high in this trait also tend to have a broad range of interests.
- They are curious about the world and other people and eager to learn new things and enjoy new experiences.
- People who are high in this trait tend to be more adventurous and creative.
- People low in this trait are often much more traditional and may struggle with abstract thinking.

### High

- Very creative
- Open to trying new things
- Focused on tackling new challenges
- Happy to think about abstract concepts.

### Low

- Dislikes change
- Does not enjoy new things
- Resists new ideas
- Not very imaginative
- Dislikes abstract or theoretical concepts.

## Conscientiousness

- Standard features of this dimension include high levels of thoughtfulness, good impulse control, and goal-directed behaviors.
- Highly conscientious people tend to be organized and mindful of details.
- They plan ahead, think about how their behavior affects others, and are mindful of deadlines.

### High

- Spends time preparing
- Finishes important tasks right away
- Pays attention to detail
- Enjoys having a set schedule

### Low

- Dislikes structure and schedules
- Makes messes and doesn't take care of things
- Fails to return things or put them back where they belong
- Procrastinates important tasks
- Fails to complete necessary or assigned tasks

## Extroversion

- Extroversion is characterized by excitability, sociability, talkativeness, assertiveness, and high amounts of emotional expressiveness.
- People who are high in extraversion are outgoing and tend to gain energy in social situations. Being around other people helps them feel energized and excited.
- People who are low in extraversion (or introverted) tend to be more reserved and have less energy to expend in social settings.

### High

- Enjoys being the center of attention
- Likes to start conversations
- Enjoys meeting new people
- Has a wide social circle of friends and acquaintances
- Finds it easy to make new friends
- Feels energized when around other people
- Say things before thinking about them

### Low

- Prefers solitude
- Feels exhausted when having to socialize a lot
- Finds it difficult to start conversations
- Dislikes making small talk
- Carefully thinks things through before speaking
- Dislikes being the center of attention

## Agreeableness

- This personality dimension includes attributes such as trust, altruism, kindness, affection, and other prosocial behaviors.
- People who are high in agreeableness tend to be more cooperative while those low in this trait tend to be more competitive and sometimes even manipulative.

### High

- Has a great deal of interest in other people
- Cares about others
- Feels empathy and concern for other people
- Enjoys helping and contributing to the happiness of other people
- Assists others who are in need of help

### Low

- Takes little interest in others
- Doesn't care about how other people feel
- Has little interest in other people's problems
- Insults and belittles others
- Manipulates others to get what they want

## Neuroticism

- Neuroticism is a trait characterized by sadness, moodiness, and emotional instability.
- Individuals who are high in this trait tend to experience mood swings, anxiety, irritability, and sadness.
- Those low in this trait tend to be more stable and emotionally resilient.

### High

- Experiences a lot of stress
- Worries about many different things
- Gets upset easily
- Experiences dramatic shifts in mood
- Feels anxious
- Struggles to bounce back after stressful events

### Low

- Emotionally stable
- Deals well with stress
- Rarely feels sad or depressed
- Doesn't worry much
- Is very relaxed

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## Links to OnLine Big Five Personality Tests

- <https://www.truity.com/test/big-five-personality-test>
- <https://openpsychometrics.org/tests/IPIP-BFFM/>
- <https://www.123test.com/personality-test/>
- <https://bigfive-test.com/test>
- <https://www.scienceofpeople.com/personality/>
- <https://www.idrlabs.com/big-five-subscales/test.php>

## Linki do OnLine Big Five Personality Tests in Polish

- <https://www.idrlabs.com/pl/wielkiej-piatki-osobowosci-30-podskal/test.php>
- <https://bigfive-test.com/pl>



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Thank You very much  
for your attention